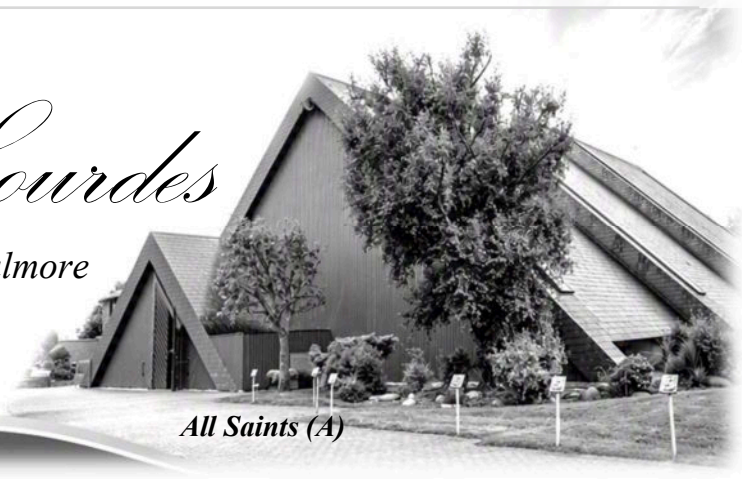
THE CHURCH OF

# Our Lady of Lourdes

*Serving the Parishes of Steelstown & Culmore*



***Sunday 1st November 2026*** ***All Saints (A)***

## MASS TIMES

**SUNDAYS**

**Vigil:** 6.30pm
**Sunday:** 09.00am;
11.00am;
12.15pm

**WEEKDAYS**

**Monday – Friday:** 7.45am
**Monday:** 7.00pm
**Tuesday – Saturday:** 10.00am

## CONFESSIONS

**WEEKEND**

**Saturday:** After 10am Mass;
5.45pm – 6.25pm
**Sunday:** 10.30am – 10.50am

**WEEKDAYS**

**Monday**: 6.30pm – 6.55pm
**Tuesday**: 8.10am – 8.30am
**Thursday**: 9.30am – 09.50am

## DEVOTIONS

**EUCHARISTIC ADORATION**

**Thursday:** 08.00 – 09.55am
10.30am – 12 noon

**ROSARY**

Before 10am Mass

**DIVINE MERCY CHAPLET**

After 10am Mass

## PLENARY INDULGENCE

From 12 noon on 1 November until midnight on 2 November all who have confessed, received Holy Communion and prayed for the Pope's intentions (one Our Father and Hail Mary, or any other prayer of one's choice) can gain one plenary indulgence by visiting a Church or oratory and there reciting one Our Father and the Apostle's Creed. This indulgence is applicable only to the souls of the departed. Confession may be made at any time within the week preceding or the week following 1 November. Holy Communion may be received on any day from 1 November to 8 November. The faithful who visit a cemetery and pray for the dead may gain a plenary indulgence applicable only to the Holy Souls on the usual conditions once per day from 1 to 8 November.
The conditions mentioned above apply also for this.

## A PRAYER FOR THE DEAD

Lord, be with us in these November days of darkness. In our anxiety and fear help us to remember that death is the dawning of eternal life.
Give to those who have died freedom from pain and bring them to the peace of heaven. In moments of sadness may we experience the closeness of your friendship and may we always know the strength of your presence.
We ask this through Christ our Lord.
Amen

**PARISH OFFICE**
Wednesday – Friday: 9am – 3pm
028 7135 1718
steelstown@derrydiocese.org / culmoreparish@derrydiocese.org

**PRIEST**
Rev. Declan McGeehan P.P./Adm.
declan.mcgeehan@derrydiocese.org
Urgent sick calls: 073 5238 7817

**REMEMBERING OUR FAITHFUL DEPARTED**

**1 NOVEMBER THE FEAST OF ALL SAINTS**
Sunday 1 Nov is the Feast of All Saints. Mass times are 9am, 11am and 12.15pm.

**MONDAY 2 NOVEMBER ALL SOULS DAY**
Monday 2 Nov is All Souls Day. Mass times are 7.45am, 10am and 7pm.

Parishioners and friends who have died since November last year will have a special place in our prayer on Monday 16th November. Their names will be read out at the 7pm Mass on Monday 16th. During this Mass, the names of those who died in the past year will be called out, and a member of each family will be invited to bring forward a candle for their loved one.

**IN MEMORIAM –** We pray for the happy repose of the souls of: Michael McLaughlin; Roseann McCallion; Mary Coyle; Grace Doherty; Tommy Mitchell; Emily Oakley; Rose Coyle; Rosaline Gillen; Eamonn Gillen and Siobhan McEleney.

**COLLECTION -** Last Sunday's Collection amounted to £3,365.00. Thank you for your generosity.

**COLUMBAN YOUNG ADULTS –** for those aged 18-35, who are seeking a community of like-minded young adults who have Christ at the centre of their lives. The next gathering will take place on Thursday 19th November, 7pm, in our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, Derry. Bishop Donal McKeown will lead a holy hour and meditation, followed by pizza and refreshments in the Conference Room. New members always welcome! For further information contact: columbanyoungadults@gmail.com or follow us on social media.

**STEELSTOWN BRIAN ÓGS SENIOR LADIES** – Good luck to Steelstown Brian Ógs senior ladies in the Ulster Senior Club Championship semi-final today, Sunday 1 November.

**BIBLE ALIVE RENEWAL REMINDER -** The Parish order of Bible Alive is due for renewal in November. Bible Alive is a monthly booklet which provides commentary and reflection for the readings used at Mass each day plus articles relating to scripture, prayer and life. If you wish to order Bible Alive for the next year, please contact the Sacristan. Cost is £30 per year or £3 per month. If paying by cheque, please make payable to: 'Our Lady of Lourdes Church'.

**MINSTRY TO THE SICK –** If you would be willing to visit and pray with the sick in the nursing homes here in Steelstown and Culmore Parishes, please contact the Parish Office with your details.

**THE PADRE PIO PRAYER GROUP** - Holy Family Chapel, Ballymagroarty, will take place on Tuesday 3 November. Starting with Rosary at 6.45pm before Mass and will finish with a blessing with a first class relic of St. Pio, after the Novena.

**MATT TALBOT PRAYER SOCIETY** - Monthly Mass on Monday 2 November at 7.30pm in St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry. Everyone is welcome: Mass is offered for enrolled members of the society and their families. Anyone dealing with addiction either personally or within their families is encouraged to attend. Spiritual Packs for the Protection of family homes from Drugs will be distributed after Mass. To enrol yourself or someone else please email: vita@matttalbotprayersociety.com.

**CRAFT FAIR** - Carnhill Community Centre, (the wee grey hut), are holding a Christmas Craft Fair on Saturday the 7 November 2026. 11am.-3pm. £1 admission, children under 11 are free. Please support your local craftworkers.

**POPE'S INTENTION FOR NOVEMBER -** For the proper use of wealth. Let us pray for the proper use of wealth, that not succumbing to the temptation of selfishness, it may always be put at the service of the common good and solidarity of those who have less.

**SAFEGUARDING NOTICE –** We are committed to ensuring the safety and well-being of everyone in our parishes. If you have any concerns regarding the safeguarding of children or adults in need of protection within the Church, please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person, on 07596 500793; or email: marie.okane@derrydiocese.org

# Parishes of Glendermott & Strathfoyle

Sunday 25th October 2026

Thirtieth Sunday in Ordinary Time

## The Commandment of Love

Love is the greatest of the commandments, the mother of all the virtues, and the pulsating heart of the Christian message. We are created in the image of a God who is Love; so, we cannot live without love

In today's gospel reading from Matthew, one of the Pharisees, a lawyer, asks Jesus to identify 'the greatest commandment of the Law' (Mt 22:36). In response, Jesus quotes the great 'shema' prayer recited daily by all devout Jews (cf. Deut 6:4-5). This prayer exhorts us to love God with our whole heart, mind and soul. Jesus immediately adds a second commandment, familiar to his audience namely, 'love your neighbour as yourself' (Mt 22:39).

Sadly, the word 'love' is so overused in our world today that it has lost much of its meaning. We speak of love of country, love of sport, love of food, love between friends, love of parents, romantic love, etc

As Pope Leo teaches, 'True love is not merely a fleeting, briefly inflamed emotion. It is more. It is a deep commitment to the other, a decision, a journey and a covenant for life

All genuine love is manifested in action; it is practical and outgoing. In the words of St Augustine: 'It has the hands to help others. It has the feet to hasten to the poor and needy. It has the eyes to see misery and want. It has the ears to hear the sighs and sorrows of people.'

Such love is demanding. It summons us to leave our comfort zones, to give our time, our energy, our talents, and, indeed, our very selves to others

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## FEAST OF ALL SAINTS

**Mass Arrangements for the Feast of All Saints- Saturday 31st October**

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|---|---|
| **6:00pm** | **Church of Immaculate Conception** |
| **6:00pm** | **St. Oliver Plunkett** |
| **6:30pm** | **St. Columb's Church (note change of time)** |

**Diocesan Appointments** - *This weekend is Fr Lagan's last weekend in our parish as our priest, I take the opportunity to thank him sincerely for his work both in the parish and the hospitals over the past four years. His endearing personality enabled him to get to know many people in a short period of time. His good humour and generosity of time have brought many blessings to many people and our parish community.*

*As he begins a new phase of his life as Parish Priest in the Sperrin parishes of Gortin and Greencastle, I on behalf of the parish, wish him every blessing. It will be a very big change for him so let's keep him and all the priests involved in the latest diocesan appointments in our prayers.*

## Words of thanks from Fr Lagan

*On 18th August 2022, Bishop Donal McKeown appointed me to the parishes of Glendermott and Strathfoyle. On that occasion, even though it was a change, I very much knew that I was coming home. I was sent to a parish that I had previously served and for a short while after my Ordination in 2012 began ministering as a Priest. It is a place that I love very much and this last four years have been both a time of immense blessing. On 9th October, Bishop Router appointed me to the parishes of Greencastle and Gortin in Co Tyrone. Whilst I am deeply honoured for his trust in me, I leave here with the best preparation I could ask for in taking up this new challenge. I want to thank all the staff of our parish, those who work to support the running of Glendermott and Strathfoyle, but especially to Fr Joshi for his kindness, guidance, support and friendship and to Fr Michael Canny for his ever willing example, paternal guidance and endless patience not only during my time here but throughout my Priestly Ministry and also to each of you, for your prayers, your faith filled example and for the love and kindness that you have shown me, I will forever treasure. Please keep me in your prayers and be assured of my prayers for you, your loved ones and families in the months and years ahead. Thank you.*

**Baptisms** – We welcome into God's family: **Noah Doherty** Birch Hill, **Cailean John Christopher Tracey** Deramore Drive.

**Anniversaries –** For those whose anniversaries occur around this time Molly Hegarty, Nora Brown, Margaret Flynn, Jim Mellon, Fonsy Doherty, Bob Kelly, Joseph Devine, William Barr, Willie Guthrie, Paul McFadden, John Monaghan, Charlie Mullan, William McConomy, Bill and Kathleen Monk, Mary Storey, Brian Simpson, Lawerence Boyle.

**Offertory Collections**: **Glendermott: £3,800.00 Strathfoyle: £580.00**
**Thank you for your generosity to the parish collections and Mission Collection taken up last weekend**

**Vocations-** there will be a meeting for anyone considering a vocation to the diocesan priesthood, in Derry, on Sunday 8 November, beginning at 4pm. For further details, please contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, at pgoh2111@gmail.com or by calling (028) 79386259.

**Lectio Divina** – Join us on **Thursday** evenings at 8:00pm in St Columb's Church for our weekly praying of the Sacred Scriptures.

**Centring Prayer Group** – Join us on **Wednesday** at 8:00pm in the St Columb's Church (Parish Hall)

**Unlocking the Mystery of the Bible** Many of us want to read the Bible but can find it difficult to understand. The Parish will be running 'Unlocking the Mystery of the Bible', an eight-part course that will help us to understand the main story of the Bible and how all the different parts fit together. It gives the 'big picture' and helps us see what the Bible is really about. We will meet on Monday evenings starting on 2nd November at 8pm (after 7.30pm Mass) in the Parish Hall, St Columb's Church. Sessions will begin with prayer, followed by a video presentation and small group discussion. By the end, you'll feel more confident reading the Bible and have a better understanding of how you fit into God's plan. To register for the course, please leave your name and contact details at the Parish Office (028 71 342303 or email secretary@watersideparish.net).

**Annual Solemn Novena in honour of Our Lady of Perpetual Help: Nine Sundays before Christmas in Long Tower Church, Derry at 6.00pm, beginning this Sunday 25 October.** ***The theme of our Novena this year is 'Make me a Channel of your Peace – celebrating the 800th Jubilee Year of St Francis'***. Each night will comprise of the Rosary, Novena prayer and petitions with a short talk given by various guest speakers and Eucharistic Healing Ceremony with Benediction of the Blessed Sacrament.

**Choir Director: St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry,** 10 hours per week: St Eugene's Cathedral is recruiting for an experienced choir director to lead and manage all aspects of the cathedral choir. They will ensure that the music enhances worship services and aligns with the church's liturgical themes. For a job description and application pack, Tel. (028) 7126 2302 or email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Submit completed applications to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP, or email them to recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Applications must be received by noon on Thursday 12 November 2026. Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer

**Omagh Charismatic Prayer Group:** Day of Prayer, Praise and Healing, celebrating 50 years: Sunday 15th November 2026 in the Silverbirch Hotel, Omagh: Registration 9:30am, concluding in the afternoon with Mass. Theme: People of God's Delight (Ps 194.4). Speaker Fr. John Keane. Cost £40, including coffee and lunch. Book by 1ST November, please, for catering purposes: Evelyn 07876 411435 or Kathleen 07596 609041.

# Mass & Confession Times

## Sunday

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|---|---|
| **St Columb's Church** | **10.00am, 12.30pm & 6.00pm** |
| **Church of Immaculate Conception** | **10.15am & 12.15pm** |
| **St Oliver Plunkett Church** | **11.15am** |
| **St Mary's Oratory** | **9.15am** |

## Monday – Friday

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|---|---|
| **St Columb's Church** | **10.00am & 7.30pm** |
| **Church of Immaculate Conception** | **9.15am** |
| **St Oliver Plunkett's Church** | **11.00am Mon. Tues. Thurs.** |
| **St Mary's Oratory** | **11.00am – Wednesday only** |

## Saturday

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|---|---|
| **St Columb's Church** | **10.00am & 7.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)** |
| **Church of Immaculate Conception** | **6.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)** |
| **St Oliver Plunkett's Church** | **6.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)** |

**Confessions**

| | |
|---|---|
| **St Columb's Church** | **Monday – Friday 7.00pm – 7.25pm**<br>**Saturday after 10.00 Mass** |
| **Church of Immaculate Conception** | **Saturday 5.30pm – 5.55pm** |
| **St Oliver Plunkett's Church** | **Saturday 5.30pm – 5.55pm** |

**Parish Office** 32 Chapel Road, Derry BT47 2BB. Tel. 02871 342303
**Email:** secretary@watersideparish.net Web: www.watersideparish.net
**YouTube Channel:** www.youtube.com/WatersideParish

**Rev. Michael Canny PP** 02871342303 secretary@watersideparish.net
**Rev. Patrick Lagan CC** 02871342303 secretary@watersidepaish.net
**Rev Joshy Parokkaran CC** 02871342303 secretary@watersideparish.net

**SAFEGUARDING CHILDREN AND VULNERABLE ADULTS** – If you are concerned about the welfare and safety of children or a vulnerable adult contact: Designated Diocesan Person Ms Marie Gormley at 07596500793 or marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org or PSNI 101.

**Our Churches** are monitored by CCTV cameras and by live streaming. Live streaming can be viewed online at the parish website. The Diocese of Derry Privacy Notice is displayed on the parish website and Church notice board.